Authors Bio:

Light through Culture is an international design school that aims at weaving, through design, innovative technologies and culture into a new canvas for making and thinking. The school was founded in Siena in 2011 by Patrizia Marti (University of Siena) and Kees Overbeeke (Eindhoven University of Technology). During the first edition organised in partnership with University of Siena and Eindhoven University of Technology. The school was hosted at the Museum Santa Maria della Scala in Siena. An experiential path was designed to reflect on the ancient pilgrimage route along the Via Francigena, that crossed the Santa Maria della Scala, the former city hospital where the pilgrims could be given shelter and care on their way. The designed installation, a real path in the Museum underground invited the contemporary visitors as new pilgrims.

The second edition of the school was carried out in 2012 in partnership with University of Siena, Eindhoven University of Technology and Interactive Institute Umeå . The school was hosted at the Museum Santa Maria della Scala in Siena. It explored the theme of human rights and designed ways of eliciting the experience of their violations, with the realization of an experiential path through five interactive spaces in an exhibition entitled “Experiencing Human Rights”.

The third installment, Ballade of Women, focused specifically on the design of an interactive exhibition that provided deep engagement through embodiment and reflections on issues of women’s rights. The project was realized in collaboration between University of Siena, Interactive Institute Umeå and Eindhoven University of Technology and exhibited in the summer of 2013 at the Fondazione Monte Dei Paschi in Siena, Italy.